SPRINT SUMMARY — FOR BUSINESS ANALYSIS

Sentinel360: Where the Project Stands

30 July 2026

Investigation process — complete

Community app — early working version

Smart camera detection — still being built

Overview

Sentinel360 helps investigators manage a case from the moment it's opened to the moment it's closed, gives the community a way to report what they see and help identify wanted people, and will eventually add automated camera-based detection. This sprint's work focused on finishing the case-management side of the system and making sure it respects people's privacy rights under South African law.

What's Complete

The investigation process, start to finish. An investigator can open a case, get assigned to it, attach evidence, identify suspects, record an arrest, track the case through court, and close it — with every step recorded automatically so there's a clear record of who did what and when. Cases that need extra privacy (for example, involving an informant or a minor) are locked down so only the assigned investigator or a manager can see them.

Compliance with South African privacy law (POPIA). Anyone whose information is held in the system can request a copy of what's stored about them, or request that it be removed. When a removal request is approved, personal details are stripped out, but the case record itself is kept — because South African law requires evidence and legal records to be retained even after someone asks to be forgotten. That balance was worked through carefully and is documented for the project's records.

What's Working (Early Version)

The community mobile app. Members of the public can already browse a public list of wanted persons — photo, description, and charges — pulled from the same system investigators use. This mirrors something South Africans already do informally (for example, communities helping identify and recover stolen phones via social media) — the app simply gives that instinct a proper, trackable channel.

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS

Browse wanted persons	Working	Live and usable today.
Search for a specific wanted person	Not yet built	Right now people scroll the full list; a proper search box is planned for next sprint.
Report a sighting (description)	Working	Text descriptions save correctly today.
Report a sighting (photo & location)	Known issue	The app lets someone attach a photo and location, but that part isn't being saved yet — a fix is already scoped for next sprint.

What's Still Being Built

Automated camera detection (the "AI" side). This is intentionally the least mature part of the system right now. Today it can detect and track people and vehicles in a camera feed. It cannot yet recognise a specific wanted person's face automatically — that's planned as the next phase of work, not something that's been skipped or missed.

Known Limitations, Stated Plainly

- Case archiving after closure currently has to be triggered manually rather than happening automatically on a schedule.
- Existing user accounts created before the privacy update need to actively opt in to the new consent process — it isn't applied to them automatically.
- The mobile app's photo/location capture for sighting reports needs a fix before it can be relied on (see table above).
- Automated camera detection does not yet recognise specific individuals.
- Formal automated testing of the system is still minimal and needs to expand.

What's Planned for Next Sprint

- Fix the mobile sighting-report issue so photos and location save correctly.
- Add a proper search feature to the wanted-persons list in the mobile app.
- Automate case archiving so it no longer needs a manual trigger.
- Prompt existing users to complete the new privacy consent step.
- Begin the next phase of camera-based detection (recognising specific individuals).